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UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

FRIDAY, 09 OCTOBER 2026

23 must-know stories, 23 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 890 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court upholds Andhra Pradesh High Court judgment on BC reservations

The Supreme Court delivered its verdict upholding the Andhra Pradesh High Court order regarding BC reservations. The Supreme Court upheld an Andhra Pradesh High Court judgment concerning Backward Classes reservations, citing a lack of empirical data to breach the 50% ceiling. A Bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu calls the High Court order ‘very reasonable’ and says there was no empirical data to justify breaching the 50% ceiling

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** Andhra Pradesh · **Who:** Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu · **Prelims:** The Bench consisted of Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu.; The Supreme Court termed the High Court order very reasonable.; The court cited a lack of empirical data for breaching the 50 percent ceiling.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces the constitutional principle of maintaining a reservation ceiling to protect equality of opportunity.; Emphasizes the mandatory requirement of empirical data before states can breach the 50 percent limit.*

Static — The 50% ceiling on total reservations was famously laid down by the Supreme Court in the landmark Indra Sawhney case of 1992. Article 16(4) of the Constitution empowers the State to make provisions for the reservation of appointments in favor of any backward class of citizens. Exceeding the 50% limit is permissible only in extraordinary situations and requires quantifiable empirical data justifying such a step.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

The Hindu: read the source · also reported by Hindustan Times

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Monsoon Session: Lok Sabha passes Appropriation Bill, RS clears Births and Deaths Registration Amendment Bill

The Rajya Sabha passed the Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026 by voice vote. The Lok Sabha earlier approved the same Bill on July 31 and cleared the Appropriation (No. 3) Bill, 2026. The amendments introduce a strict two-tier mechanism for delayed registrations of births and deaths. Registrations delayed by over two years now require approval solely from a Judicial Magistrate of the First Class. Registrations delayed between one and two years still need approval from District Magistrates or authorised Executive Magistrates. The shift to judicial authority aims to curb fraudulent records and improve civil registration accuracy. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman also introduced the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill. Both Houses witnessed frequent disruptions and adjournments over various Opposition protests.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Nityanand Rai, Nirmala Sitharaman, Harivansh Narayan Singh · **Prelims:** The Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026 was passed by the Rajya Sabha on a Tuesday.; Registrations delayed by more than two years require approval from a Judicial Magistrate of the First Class.; The Appropriation (No. 3) Bill, 2026 covers excess spending for the financial year ending March 31, 2023.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Shifts very late birth and death registrations to judicial oversight to prevent fraud.; Ensures legislative sanction for excess government expenditure as mandated by the Constitution.*

Static — The Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969 governs the registration of births and deaths in India. The Consolidated Fund of India is established under Article 265 of the Constitution, requiring parliamentary authorisation for withdrawals. An Appropriation Bill gives the government authority to withdraw funds from the Consolidated Fund of India to meet expenditure.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Geography, Agriculture & Allied · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Madhya Pradesh High Court strikes down 27% OBC quota, says it will stay at 14%

The Madhya Pradesh High Court ruled that Other Backward Classes are entitled to a 14 percent reservation in state public services and higher education. The court declined to uphold the increase of reservation from 14 percent to 27 percent enacted via Ordinance No. 2/2019 and the Amendment Act, 2019. The court stated that data from Higher Education and Public Services shows OBCs are adequately represented and part of the mainstream under Article 16(4). It noted that no extraordinary conditions or emergent situations exist to justify exceeding the Supreme Court's 50 percent reservation ceiling set in the Indra Sawhney and Jaishri Laxmanrao Patil cases. Appointments made under the 2019 Amendment Act up to September 29, 2022, exceeding the 14 percent quota and up to 27 percent, are protected from removal. Candidates appointed in excess of 14 percent between March 2019 and September 29, 2022, will have their appointments adjusted in the next three recruitment drives. Appointments made after September 29, 2022, must adhere to an 87 percent cap, with the remaining 13 percent filled from unreserved category candidates.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** Madhya Pradesh · **Who:** Madhya Pradesh High Court, MPPSC, Madhya Pradesh State Employees Selection Board · **Prelims:** MP Ordinance No. 2/2019 and the Amendment Act, 2019 sought to increase OBC reservation from 14% to 27%.; The cut-off date protecting past OBC appointments exceeding the 14% quota is September 29, 2022.; Appointments made after September 29, 2022, are restricted to 87%, with 13% reserved for unreserved category candidates.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces the strict adherence to the 50 percent judicial ceiling on total reservations in public employment and education.; Provides legal clarity on the status of appointments made under interim arrangements between 2019 and 2022 in Madhya Pradesh.*

Static — Article 16(4) of the Constitution empowers the State to make provisions for the reservation of appointments or posts in favor of any backward class of citizens not adequately represented in the services under the State. The Supreme Court in the landmark Indra Sawhney case (1992) capped the total reservation limit at 50 percent, except in extraordinary circumstances. The 50 percent ceiling rule was reiterated by the Supreme Court in later judgments, including the Maratha reservation case (Jaishri Laxmanrao Patil v. Chief Minister).

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Social Justice & Welfare · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

Hindustan Times: read the source · *free copy on msn.com*

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Refers Constitutional Issues Regarding Governance of National Capital Territory of Delhi to Constitution Bench. The court recognized the need for clarity in the distribution of powers between the elected government and the Lieutenant Governo

The referral was ordered because the court recognized the need for clear constitutional demarcation of powers between Delhi's elected government and the Lieutenant Governor. The Supreme Court has referred constitutional questions concerning the governance of Delhi and power sharing between the elected government and the Lieutenant Governor to a Constitution Bench.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court of India, Government of NCT of Delhi, Lieutenant Governor of Delhi · **Prelims:** The matter regarding Delhi governance powers was referred to a Constitution Bench by the Supreme Court.; The dispute concerns the distribution of powers between the elected Delhi government and the Lieutenant Governor.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Tests the federal balance and representative governance principles within Union Territories.; Clarifies executive control and administrative boundaries between the Lieutenant Governor and the Delhi Cabinet.*

Static — Article 239AA of the Constitution provides special provisions for the National Capital Territory of Delhi, creating an elected legislative assembly. The 69th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1991 inserted Article 239AA and Article 239AB into the Constitution. Under Article 239AA, the Delhi Assembly can legislate on State and Concurrent List matters except public order, police, and land.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Lawtext: read the source

Governance & Policy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Rs. 62,500 crore MPMS

The Union Cabinet approved the MPMS with an outlay of Rs. 62,500 crore. The decision aims to boost advanced manufacturing capabilities in the country. The National Strategy for Additive Manufacturing has already trained over 1.54 lakh individuals. The existing initiative has supported 56 start-ups and facilitated 65 developments. Market indices Sensex and Nifty rebounded in early trade following the development. Benchmark indices gained after two days of sharp decline, led by IT stocks like TCS.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet · **Prelims:** Outlay of the approved MPMS is Rs. 62,500 crore.; National Strategy for Additive Manufacturing has trained over 1.54 lakh individuals.; The strategy supported 56 start-ups and facilitated 65 developments.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Allocates massive financial resources towards next-generation manufacturing.; Complements existing skilling and start-up support under additive manufacturing strategies.*

Static — The Union Cabinet is the premier decision-making body of the executive government in India, headed by the Prime Minister. Cabinet decisions drive major policy formulation, financial outlays, and national strategic missions across various ministries. Additive manufacturing, commonly known as 3D printing, builds objects layer by layer from digital models.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Orders National Road Crash Data System

The Supreme Court of India directed states to promptly upload road accident data on the Electronic Detailed Accident Report portal. The Court ordered the integration of eDAR with VAHAN, SARATHI, and the Insurance Information Bureau databases to create a unified digital record. This integration aims to enable seamless cross-verification of accident, vehicle registration, driving licence, and insurance details for every crash. The bench comprising Justices Ahsanuddin Amanullah and P. B. Varale issued these directions on 8 October 2026. The integrated records must cover hit-and-run cases and the PM-RAHAT scheme providing cashless treatment up to Rs. 1.5 lakh per victim. Insurers were ordered to forward suspected fraudulent claims to state Special Investigation Teams and examine potential employee involvement. The Centre, states, and authorities were given four weeks from 8 October 2026 to complete integration and file compliance reports. The Court issued contempt show-cause notices to the heads of five insurance companies over non-compliance with previous orders. The next hearing in this matter has been scheduled by the Supreme Court for 27 November 2026.

When: 8 October 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court bench comprising Justices Ahsanuddin Amanullah and P. B. Varale · **Prelims:** The eDAR portal is operated by the National Informatics Centre.; VAHAN is the national vehicle-registration database and SARATHI contains driving-licence information.; The Insurance Information Bureau functions under the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Streamlines motor accident claims processing and reduces bureaucratic delays for victims.; Enhances transparency and cross-verification to prevent fraudulent insurance claims.*

Static — The Supreme Court of India is the apex judicial body established under Article 124 of the Constitution, functioning as the ultimate court of appeal. The Electronic Detailed Accident Report portal is operated by the National Informatics Centre to digitize accident reports and speed up compensation claims. VAHAN is the national repository of vehicle registration data, and SARATHI manages national driving licence records under the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

gktoday.in: read the source · also reported by Hindustan Times

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Next round of review meeting of ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement to be held in Jan

The next round of the review meeting for the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement is scheduled to be held in India in January. The meeting will be conducted in hybrid mode to review progress made by sub-committees and guide timely conclusion of negotiations. The commerce ministry stated that ASEAN hosted the 15th AITIGA Joint Committee and related meetings at the ASEAN Secretariat in Jakarta. The Jakarta meetings took place from October 6 to October 9 to review ongoing progress and negotiations. The joint committee directed all sub-committees to expedite pending chapters and establish firm, time-bound deliverables. ASEAN is a major trade partner, accounting for about 11 per cent share in India's global trade. The original India-ASEAN free trade agreement in goods was signed back in 2009. Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal noted that sustainability-linked trade measures and digital trade are reshaping the global trade agenda.

When: January (next year / 2027) and October 6-9 · **Where:** New Delhi, India and Jakarta, Indonesia · **Who:** Commerce Ministry and Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal · **Prelims:** The India-ASEAN free trade agreement in goods was signed in 2009.; ASEAN accounts for about 11 per cent share in India's global trade.; The 15th AITIGA Joint Committee and related meetings were held in Jakarta, Indonesia.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for enhancing bilateral economic cooperation and addressing trade deficits between India and ASEAN nations.; Helps streamline modern trade concerns such as digital trade and sustainability measures.*

Static — The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) is a regional intergovernmental organization established on August 8, 1967, by Indonesia, Malaysia, the Philippines, Singapore, and Thailand. ASEAN currently comprises 10 Southeast Asian member states and aims to promote intergovernmental cooperation and economic integration. The India-ASEAN Free Trade Agreement (AITIGA) was signed in 2009 and came into force to boost economic ties and bilateral trade in goods.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU, Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on ptinews.com · also reported by PIB

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Quad nations launch $20 billion critical minerals initiative to strengthen supply chains

India, Australia, Japan, and the United States unveiled the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative Framework on Tuesday. The initiative aims to support the development of secure, diversified, and fair critical minerals supply chains for advanced technologies. Quad partners intend to mobilise up to USD 20 billion in government and private sector support to strengthen supply chains. Support will cover mining, processing, and recycling projects through new and existing mechanisms. Projects with a Quad nexus will be identified to address critical supply chain gaps across member nations. Countries plan to use export credit agencies, development finance institutions, loans, guarantees, and equity participation. Partners will share best practices on permitting, licensing, regulatory processes, geological mapping, and technology development. The framework emphasizes addressing non-market policies and unfair trade practices through coordinated measures. Nations agreed to strengthen cooperation in recycling and recovery of critical minerals from e-waste and scrap materials.

When: Tuesday · **Who:** India, Australia, Japan, United States, S. Jaishankar, Marco Rubio, Penny Wong, Toshimitsu Motegi · **Prelims:** The initiative aims to mobilise up to USD 20 billion in government and private sector support.; Participants include India, Australia, Japan, and the United States.; The announcement was made alongside the Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps India secure access to essential critical minerals needed for advanced technologies and green energy transitions.; Reduces supply chain vulnerabilities and dependencies on dominant single-source markets.*

Static — The Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (Quad) is an informal strategic forum comprising India, the United States, Japan, and Australia. The grouping focuses on maintaining a free, open, and inclusive Indo-Pacific region through diplomatic and economic cooperation. Critical minerals like lithium, cobalt, and rare earths are essential for manufacturing advanced electronics, electric vehicles, and renewable energy equipment.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: International Relations, Infrastructure & Energy

ddnews.gov.in: read the source · also reported by Economic Times

GS2 MAKE NOTES

PM Modi, Anthony Albanese hold third India-Australia Annual Summit, expand strategic partnership across key sectors

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Australian PM Anthony Albanese held the third India-Australia Annual Summit in Melbourne on Thursday. The leaders reviewed bilateral progress since the launch of the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in 2020. A major focus was strengthening economic engagement and concluding an ambitious Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement at the earliest. Both leaders discussed expanding cooperation in defence, security, critical minerals, cyber technologies, space, and clean energy. Education was highlighted as a key pillar, noting the growing presence of Australian universities in India. Australia announced the voluntary return of several Indian cultural artefacts originating from Tamil Nadu. The summit concluded with a wide-ranging package of agreements covering maritime security, civil nuclear cooperation, and filmmaking. The leaders reaffirmed their commitment to maintaining a free, open, inclusive and prosperous Indo-Pacific region.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** Melbourne, Australia · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese · **Prelims:** The third India-Australia Annual Summit was held in Melbourne.; Australia agreed to return cultural artefacts originating from Tamil Nadu, including a stone sculpture of Nandi.; The artefacts to be returned include a metal trident with Goddess Bhadrakali and a six-headed stone statue of Lord Kartikeya.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Advances bilateral economic integration through ongoing negotiations for a Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement.; Strengthens strategic and defence collaboration, reinforcing regional stability in the Indo-Pacific.*

Static — India and Australia established a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in 2020 during a virtual summit between the two Prime Ministers. The Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement (ECTA) between India and Australia entered into force in December 2022. Both nations are key members of the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (Quad), along with the United States and Japan, focusing on Indo-Pacific security.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

India, UAE ink major pacts on energy, defence, AI; Abu Dhabi commits $5 billion investment

India and the UAE signed multiple agreements across energy, defence, maritime infrastructure, and emerging technologies during the Prime Minister's visit to Abu Dhabi. The agreements were driven by a mutual desire to expand bilateral trade and cooperation, building on the success of the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement. The core issue centres on deepening strategic, financial, and technological integration between the two nations, particularly in critical sectors like AI and energy security. The UAE announced total investments worth USD 5 billion in India through multiple entities, including ENDB, ADIA, and International Holding Company. In energy, Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserves Limited and ADNOC signed a pact for petroleum and gas reserves, alongside a long-term LPG supply arrangement between IOCL and ADNOC. A Framework for Strategic Defence Partnership was signed to enhance industrial collaboration, maritime security, cyber defence, and secure communications. Maritime cooperation expanded via an MoU between Cochin Shipyard and Drydocks World for a ship repair cluster at Vadinar under the Maritime Development Fund Scheme. C-DAC and G42 partnered to establish an 8 Exaflop Super Compute Cluster, and a Virtual Trade Corridor was operationalised through the MAITRI digital platform.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** Abu Dhabi, UAE · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi, UAE President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan · **Prelims:** Emirates New Development Bank announced USD 3 billion investment in RBL Bank.; Abu Dhabi Investment Authority and NIIF committed USD 1 billion for infrastructure projects.; International Holding Company invested USD 1 billion in Sammaan Capital.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Significantly enhances India's energy security through strategic petroleum and gas reserve partnerships with ADNOC.; Drives India's AI Mission and supercomputing capabilities via the partnership between C-DAC and G42.*

Static — The India-UAE Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement is a landmark free trade deal designed to significantly boost bilateral merchandise and services trade. Abu Dhabi Investment Authority is a sovereign wealth fund owned by the Emirate of Abu Dhabi, investing globally on behalf of its government. C-DAC operates under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, serving as the premier R&D organization for high-performance computing in India.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: International Relations, Defence, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

PM Modi, President Prabowo Subianto hold wide-ranging talks to deepen India-Indonesia strategic partnership

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto held wide-ranging bilateral talks in Jakarta to review the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership. The discussions covered cooperation across defence, trade, technology, maritime security, healthcare, education, critical minerals, and rare earths. Both leaders welcomed the launch of the Indonesia Open Network based on India's Open Network for Digital Commerce architecture. PM Modi announced that India and Indonesia will jointly celebrate 2027 as the Tagore-Dewantara Year of Cultural and Educational Diplomacy. The leaders reaffirmed their commitment to a free, open, inclusive, and rules-based Indo-Pacific and discussed strengthening the ASEAN-India partnership. PM Modi underscored the MAHASAGAR initiative as a framework for promoting regional security and stability across the Indian Ocean Region. President Prabowo conveyed Indonesia's full support for India's Presidency of BRICS in 2026. The leaders witnessed the exchange of multiple MoUs covering defence, critical minerals, outer space, steel supply chains, and disaster management. India will also support the conservation and restoration of the UNESCO World Heritage-listed Prambanan Temple Complex in Yogyakarta.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** Jakarta, Indonesia · **Who:** PM Narendra Modi, President Prabowo Subianto, Ajit Doval, Vikram Misri · **Prelims:** The talks were held at the Istana Merdeka (Presidential Palace) in Jakarta.; President Prabowo Subianto was the Chief Guest at India's 76th Republic Day celebrations in January 2025.; The Indonesia Open Network (ION) is based on India's ONDC architecture.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Expands India's technological and digital footprint internationally through the adaptation of ONDC into the Indonesia Open Network.; Deepens strategic and defence collaboration, advancing India's Indo-Pacific vision and the MAHASAGAR initiative.*

Static — India and Indonesia share a civilizational relationship spanning over two millennia, deeply rooted in historical maritime trade, cultural, and spiritual exchanges. India-Indonesia diplomatic relations were established in 1950, and elevated to a Strategic Partnership in 2005, followed by a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in 2018. Defence and security cooperation forms a vital pillar of bilateral ties, featuring regular joint exercises like Garuda Shakti and Samudra Shakti.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

Health

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Union Health Ministry Proposes Tighter Curbs on Advertising of Prescription Drugs by Retailers and Wholesalers

The Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare proposed stricter regulations governing the advertisement of prescription medicines by pharmacies, wholesalers, and other licensed drug sellers. The trigger for this move follows recommendations from the 93rd meeting of the Drugs Technical Advisory Board held in February 2026. The core issue is to close a regulatory gap where advertising restrictions previously applied only to manufacturers rather than retail and wholesale distributors. The draft rules require advertisements for medicines under Schedules H, H1, and X to obtain prior approval from the Central Government. The ministry proposed inserting sub-rule (22) under Rule 65 of the Drugs Rules, 1945, to cover entities licensed to sell, stock, exhibit, offer for sale, or distribute drugs. The initiative aims to strengthen supply chain oversight and prevent the unauthorised promotion of sensitive drugs directly to consumers. Officials believe the rules will help curb self-medication risks regarding antibiotics, psychotropic substances, and other drugs requiring professional medical supervision. Stakeholders and the public have 30 days from the Gazette notification dated 28 September 2026 to submit objections and suggestions.

When: 28 September 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Drugs Technical Advisory Board · **Prelims:** The draft amendment proposes inserting sub-rule (22) under Rule 65 of the Drugs Rules, 1945.; The notification is dated 28 September 2026 under Gazette Notification G.S.R. 861(E).; Schedule H alone covers more than 500 medicines commonly used in medical treatment.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It helps curb inappropriate self-medication and prevents the direct marketing of habit-forming and antibiotic drugs to consumers.; It closes a critical regulatory loophole in the pharmaceutical supply chain by holding retailers and wholesalers accountable.*

Static — The Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940, and the Drugs Rules, 1945, regulate the import, manufacture, distribution, and sale of drugs and cosmetics in India. Schedule H and Schedule H1 drugs comprise prescription-only medicines, including potent antibiotics, which must be sold only against a valid medical prescription. Schedule X contains psychotropic and habit-forming substances that are subject to strict manufacturing, stocking, and retailing controls.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Health, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

PIB: read the source · free copy on thehansindia.com · also reported by The New Indian Express

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

WHO Pandemic Agreement

India delivered its official intervention on the Political Declaration on Pandemic Prevention, Preparedness, and Response at the UN High-Level Meeting in New York. Unresolved negotiations over the Pathogen Access and Benefit-Sharing System have exposed a sharp geopolitical divide between the Global North and South. The WHO Pandemic Agreement aims to ensure equitable pandemic preparedness through PABS, One Health, technology transfer, and resilient supply chains. The treaty is a legally binding international instrument negotiated under Article 19 of the WHO Constitution by the Intergovernmental Negotiating Body. Key concerns during negotiations include vaccine apartheid during COVID-19, pathogen sharing without reciprocity, and the rise of zoonotic threats like H5N1 and Mpox. Key pillars include the PABS system, One Health integration, technology transfer on mutually agreed terms, and a Global Supply Chain and Logistics Network. Major challenges involve diluted intellectual property flexibilities, deadlocks over PABS quotas, unfunded One Health mandates, and concerns over national sovereignty. India advocated for respect for national sovereignty, affordable access to countermeasures, and the use of its Digital Public Infrastructure as a global public good.

When: September 2026 · **Where:** New York · **Who:** India, Intergovernmental Negotiating Body, World Health Organization · **Prelims:** The WHO Pandemic Agreement is negotiated under Article 19 of the WHO Constitution.; The first binding convention created under Article 19 was the 2003 WHO Framework Convention on Tobacco Control.; The Vaccine Maitri initiative supplied over 300 million COVID-19 vaccine doses to nearly 100 countries.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's role as a bridge between the Global North and Global South in global health negotiations.; Showcases India's contributions through Vaccine Maitri and its identity as the Pharmacy of the World.*

Static — The WHO Pandemic Agreement is a legally binding international treaty negotiated under Article 19 of the WHO Constitution by over 190 member states through the Intergovernmental Negotiating Body. It is only the second binding convention created under Article 19 in the WHO's history, following the 2003 WHO Framework Convention on Tobacco Control. The World Health Organization is a specialized agency of the United Nations responsible for international public health, headquartered in Geneva, Switzerland.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Health · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

drishtiias.com: read the source

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Statistics ministry proposes common framework to calculate state GDP

The proposal was made because current state estimates lack private final consumption expenditure data, creating a notable gap. The statistics ministry has proposed a common framework utilizing an expenditure approach under a revised 2022-23 base year to estimate state gross domestic product. Proposed methods include using administrative data to allocate estimates across states and union territories. This initiative aims to improve consistency and comparability of GSDP estimates throughout India.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Statistics Ministry · **Prelims:** The proposed framework uses a revised base year of 2022-23.; The approach proposed for the framework is the expenditure approach.; Currently, no Indian state compiles estimates of private final consumption expenditure.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Ensures better consistency and comparability of economic data across different states and union territories in India.; Fills critical data gaps regarding private final consumption expenditure at the sub-national level.*

Static — Gross State Domestic Product represents the sum of value added by all producers within the geographical boundaries of a state. The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation is the nodal agency in India for planned statistical development and coordination of macroeconomic data. Base year revisions are periodically undertaken to account for structural changes in the economy, technological advancements, and relative price shifts.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI tightens liquidity after rate rise, raises daily CRR maintenance to 99%

The Reserve Bank of India raised the minimum daily cash reserve ratio maintenance requirement for banks to 99% from 90%. The revision aims to manage surplus liquidity in the banking system and takes effect from the fortnight beginning October 16, 2026. The decision followed a review of prevailing liquidity conditions, with the banking surplus standing at Rs. 5.03 lakh crore on Tuesday. Banks must still maintain the prescribed CRR on an average basis over the reporting fortnight, but day-to-day flexibility is reduced. The central bank is tightening day-to-day liquidity without increasing the overall CRR rate itself. Governor Sanjay Malhotra stated that the RBI would use an appropriate mix of liquidity management tools to align rates. The Monetary Policy Committee raised the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50% and shifted its stance to calibrated tightening. Additionally, the RBI announced a Rs. 25,000 crore bond sale scheduled for October 13 to align overnight rates with the repo rate.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India, Governor Sanjay Malhotra, Monetary Policy Committee · **Prelims:** Daily CRR maintenance requirement raised to 99% from 90%.; Effective date for revised CRR rule is October 16, 2026.; Repo rate raised by 25 basis points to 5.50%.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps the central bank effectively absorb surplus liquidity and manage short-term money market rates.; Reduces daily flexibility for commercial banks, compelling them to hold higher daily cash reserves with the RBI.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India is India's central banking institution, established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. The Cash Reserve Ratio refers to the minimum proportion of a bank's total deposits that must be maintained in cash with the RBI. The Monetary Policy Committee is a statutory body constituted under Section 45ZB of the RBI Act to fix the benchmark policy interest rate.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Business Standard: read the source · free copy on cnbctv18.com · also reported by RBI

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI Signals Calibrated Tightening as World Bank Lifts India’s Growth Outlook to 7.1%

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra clarified that the central bank's calibrated tightening stance rules out rate cuts, leaving only hikes or pauses on the table. The RBI raised the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50% to manage headline CPI inflation, which is expected to average around 5.8% over the next three quarters. The World Bank upgraded India's FY27 growth forecast to 7.1%, driven by strong industrial, manufacturing, services, and investment growth. Dr. Rajiv Kumar noted that private capex rising to 11.9% triggered the upgrade, though downside risks include potential below-normal rainfall and global protectionism. The government established an FTA Utilization Cell to maximize trade agreement benefits and drive genuine two-way economic integration. India is building domestic rare earth permanent magnet manufacturing capacity through a Rs. 7,280 crore scheme approved in November 2025 to reduce dependence on China. Saudi Aramco CEO Amin Nasser warned that global oil inventories are severely depleted due to the Iran war, with rebuilding expected to take up to two years.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** India · **Who:** RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra, Dr. Rajiv Kumar, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agarwal, Saudi Aramco CEO Amin Nasser · **Prelims:** The RBI raised the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50%.; The World Bank lifted its FY27 growth projection for India to 7.1%.; India holds 767 million tonnes of identified rare earth ore resources.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the RBI's proactive stance in managing inflation expectations without severely hindering economic momentum.; Reflects strong investor confidence and structural growth drivers reflected in the upgraded World Bank projections.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is India's central banking institution, established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) is a statutory body under Section 45ZB of the RBI Act to fix the benchmark interest rate. Rare earth

elements comprise 17 chemically similar metallic elements crucial for high-tech applications, defense systems, electric vehicles, and wind turbines.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, International Relations · Prelims angle: Report/Index

ddnews.gov.in: read the source · also reported by Policy Circle

GS3 MAKE NOTES

UPI merchant fee rollout scheduled for October 15 may be pushed to January: Report

The government is reportedly considering postponing the rollout of the Merchant Discount Rate on large UPI payments by a few months from October 15 to January. The delay aims to allow payment firms time to update their systems and to avoid disruption during the Indian festive season. A final decision on the postponement is yet to be taken by the National Payments Corporation of India. Under the new framework, merchants accepting UPI payments above Rs. 2,000 will have to pay a fee of 0.4% of the transaction value, capped at Rs. 300. Person-to-person transfers, P2M payments up to Rs. 2,000, P2PM payments, and RuPay debit card transactions are exempted from the charge. Payments to four specific categories—railways, telecom services, insurance, and fuel—will attract a flat Rs. 5 fee irrespective of the transaction amount. Parliament cleared the Taxation and Other Laws Amendment Bill on August 11, amending Section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, to permit these charges.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** India · **Who:** National Payments Corporation of India · **Prelims:** MDR fee applies to UPI payments above Rs. 2,000 at 0.4% or a flat Rs. 5 for specific sectors.; Four exempted categories include P2P transfers, P2M payments up to Rs. 2,000, P2PM payments, and RuPay debit card transactions.; P2PM category constitutes small vendors receiving up to Rs. 1 lakh a month directly into bank accounts.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Impacts millions of merchants and payment service providers operating in India's digital economy.; Brings changes to the long-standing zero-fee structure for UPI transactions above Rs. 2,000.*

Static — The National Payments Corporation of India is an umbrella organisation for operating retail payments and settlement systems in India, set up by RBI and IBA under the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007. Merchant Discount Rate is the fee charged to a merchant by a bank for accepting payments from customers through digital payment modes. The Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007 provides for the regulation and supervision of payment systems in India and designates the Reserve Bank of India as the authority for it.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Report/Index

Hindustan Times: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

GST 2.0 Upgrade: Key Reforms and GST Council Decisions

The 57th GST Council meeting introduced major process and enforcement reforms to ease registration, refunds, and litigation. The reforms aim to shift towards trust-based enforcement by reducing coercive powers and lowering compliance burdens for businesses. The core issue is balancing taxpayer rights and ease of doing business with strict action against fraud, fake invoices, and ITC misuse. The prosecution threshold is proposed to be raised from Rs 1 crore to Rs 5 crore, and general penalty is reduced to Rs 10,000. Goods in inter-State movement can now be inspected or detained only by supplier or destination State officers with specific intelligence and authorization. Registration is streamlined with 61 percent of taxpayers receiving automatic registration within three working days, and small e-commerce sellers can register in one State. Refund acknowledgements are shortened to 10 days, with 90 percent of claims released within three working days of acknowledgement. An optional annual-return scheme is proposed for B2C businesses with turnover up to Rs 5 crore, along with faceless assessment for Central GST. Most of these changes are expected to be implemented from 1 April 2027 to improve predictability and business cash flows.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** India · **Who:** GST Council, Union Finance Minister · **Prelims:** Prosecution threshold proposed to rise from Rs 1 crore to Rs 5 crore.; General penalty reduced from Rs 25,000 to Rs 10,000.; 61% of taxpayers currently receive automatic registration within three working days.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces compliance costs and litigation friction for MSMEs and small e-commerce firms.; Improves business cash flows through quicker refunds and smoother Input Tax Credit release.*

Static — The GST Council is a constitutional body established under Article 279A, inserted by the 101st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2016. It is chaired by the Union Finance Minister and includes the Union Minister of State for Finance/Revenue and State Finance/Taxation Ministers. It embodies cooperative federalism where the Centre has one-third of the weighted voting power and States collectively have two-thirds.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

nextias.com: read the source · also reported by Economic Times, Business Standard

GS3 MAKE NOTES

GST reforms 2026: Govt plans faceless, centralised CGST system for 2 lakh multi-jurisdiction taxpayers

The government is planning to introduce a faceless, centralised Central GST system covering scrutiny, audits, adjudication, appeals, and taxpayer services for businesses operating across multiple jurisdictions. GST reforms 2026 will move around 2 lakh businesses operating across multiple CGST jurisdictions towards a centralised, faceless tax administration, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said. The framework will cover scrutiny, audits, adjudication, appeals and taxpayer services, with public consultation planned before Budget 2027 and implementation targeted for FY28.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman · **Prelims:** Around 2 lakh businesses will be covered under the new system.; The framework will handle scrutiny, audits, adjudication, appeals, and taxpayer services.; Public consultation is planned before Budget 2027.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces compliance burdens and bureaucratic friction for businesses operating across multiple tax jurisdictions in India.; Enhances transparency, accountability, and efficiency in tax administration through technology-driven faceless scrutiny and audits.*

Static — The Goods and Services Tax (GST) is an indirect tax levied in India on the supply of goods and services, introduced via the 101st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2016. The GST Council is a constitutional body established under Article 279A, chaired by the Union Finance Minister with state finance ministers as members. Central Goods and Services Tax (CGST) is levied by the Central Government on intra-state supplies of goods and services under the CGST Act, 2017.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

Economic Times: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

The Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (Amendment) Bill, 2026

The Bill was officially reported through a PIB release on October 9, 2026. The government proposed the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development Amendment Bill, 2026 to update MSME regulations.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises · **Prelims:** The Bill is titled The Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (Amendment) Bill, 2026.; It was reported via a PIB release on 2026-10-09.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It directly impacts the regulatory ecosystem governing millions of small businesses across India.; It helps UPSC aspirants understand legislative updates in industrial policy and MSME governance.*

Static — The Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development Act was originally enacted in 2006 to facilitate the promotion and development of MSMEs. MSMEs are classified broadly into manufacturing and service enterprises based on investment in plant and machinery or equipment and annual turnover. The Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises designs policies, programmes, and schemes for the growth of this sector.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

PIB: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India launches CBDC-based digital food currency pilot in Puducherry

The government launched a pilot project using Central Bank Digital Currency to distribute food subsidies under PMGKAY in Puducherry. The initiative makes delivery of food benefits more transparent, efficient, and secure using the digital rupee for Direct Benefit Transfer. The pilot was inaugurated on February 26, 2026, by Union Minister Pralhad Joshi, alongside local leaders and senior officials. Food subsidies are credited directly to beneficiaries as programmable digital currency coupons known as eRs. in their CBDC wallets. These digital coupons, generated by the Reserve Bank of India, are purpose-bound and can only be used to buy foodgrains. Beneficiaries redeem the digital coupons at Fair Price Shops and authorised merchant outlets to obtain entitled foodgrains. The system builds upon the Jan Dhan-Aadhaar-Mobile framework and includes special provisions for feature phone users to widen outreach.

When: February 26, 2026 · **Where:** Puducherry · **Who:** Pralhad Joshi, K. Kailashnathan, N. Rangasamy · **Prelims:** The pilot project was launched in Puducherry.; The digital currency coupons are generated by the Reserve Bank of India.; The scheme distributes food subsidies under the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Enhances transparency and efficiency in the Public Distribution System.; Ensures purpose-bound expenditure, preventing diversion of food subsidies.*

Static — Central Bank Digital Currency is a digital form of legal tender issued by the Reserve Bank of India, mirroring physical currency. Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana is a flagship food security program under the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, providing free foodgrains to poor citizens. Direct Benefit Transfer aims to transfer subsidies directly into beneficiary bank accounts, reducing leakages and intermediary corruption.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

Environment & Ecology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet clears India’s climate targets for 2031–35; emissions intensity cut target raised to 47%

The Union Cabinet approved India’s updated Nationally Determined Contribution for the period 2031–2035 under the Paris Agreement. The updated targets aim to align India's development priorities with climate responsibility while advancing the vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047. India has pledged to reduce the emissions intensity of its GDP by 47 per cent by 2035 compared to 2005 levels. The country has set a target to achieve 60 per cent of its cumulative electric power installed capacity from non-fossil sources by 2035. India aims to create an additional carbon sink of 3.5 to 4 billion tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent through forest and tree cover by 2035. India achieved its previous targets ahead of the 2030 deadline, with emissions intensity declining by 36 per cent between 2005 and 2020. Non-fossil fuel capacity reached over 52 per cent as of February 2026, surpassing earlier targets ahead of schedule. Key supporting initiatives include the National Green Hydrogen Mission, PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana, and the Lifestyle for Environment initiative.

When: 2026-10-09 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Narendra Modi · **Prelims:** Emissions intensity cut target raised to 47 per cent by 2035 compared to 2005 levels.; Target to achieve 60 per cent of cumulative electric power installed capacity from non-fossil sources by 2035.; Additional carbon sink target of 3.5 to 4 billion tonnes of CO2 equivalent by 2035.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Demonstrates India's continued global leadership and commitment to ambitious climate action under the Paris Agreement.; Aligns long-term green transition goals with the vision of achieving net-zero emissions by 2070 and Viksit Bharat by 2047.*

Static — Nationally Determined Contributions are national climate plans under the Paris Agreement of 2015, highlighting efforts to reduce national emissions and adapt to climate impacts. The Paris Agreement is a legally binding international treaty on climate change adopted at COP21 in Paris, aiming to limit global warming to well below 2 degrees Celsius. India's climate framework is implemented domestically through the National Action Plan on Climate Change, launched in 2008 by the Prime Minister's Council on Climate Change.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Governance & Policy

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

Defence

GS3 MAKE NOTES

DRDO conducts flight test of long-range land attack cruise missile

DRDO conducted a successful flight test of the indigenously developed Long Range Land Attack Cruise Missile on Monday. The test was carried out from Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island off the coast of Odisha. All test objectives were fully met and verified by tracking instruments deployed by the Integrated Test Range at Chandipur. The flight test validated critical technologies and demonstrated India's growing long-range precision strike capability. Senior officials from DRDO, user representatives from the Indian Navy and Indian Air Force witnessed the launch. Aeronautical Development Establishment in Bengaluru served as the nodal laboratory for developing the missile. Sub-systems of the missile were developed indigenously by various DRDO laboratories and Indian industry partners. The successful test advances India towards the Aatmanirbhar Bharat goal and a stronger national defence ecosystem.

When: Monday · **Where:** Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island, Odisha · **Who:** DRDO, Indian Navy, Indian Air Force, Aeronautical Development Establishment · **Prelims:** The LRLACM test was conducted from Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island off the coast of Odisha.; Aeronautical Development Establishment, Bengaluru, is the nodal laboratory for the LRLACM project.; Tracking instruments for the test were deployed by the Integrated Test Range, Chandipur.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Demonstrates India's growing long-range precision strike capability and advanced defence technology.; Bolsters the Make in India initiative by showcasing indigenous design and sub-system development through domestic industry partners.*

Static — The Defence Research and Development Organisation is the premier agency under the Department of Defence Research and Development in the Ministry of Defence, Government of India. Established in 1958, DRDO is tasked with designing and developing cutting-edge defence technologies and systems for the Indian Armed Forces. Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island, formerly Wheeler Island, is located off the coast of Odisha and serves as India's primary missile testing facility.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Science & Technology

ddnews.gov.in: read the source · also reported by Indianmasterminds

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PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

ECONOMY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

RBI launches Quarterly Order Books, Inventories and Capacity Utilisation Survey: July – September 2026 (Round 75)

The RBI announced the launch of Round 75 of the survey covering the reference period of July to September 2026. The Reserve Bank of India has launched the 75th round of its quarterly Order Books, Inventories and Capacity Utilisation Survey for the manufacturing sector.

RBI: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

UP Cabinet Approves Rs. 1,725 Crore Skill Training Scheme Across 75 Districts, Plans 9 Employment Zones & 5

The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet approved the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Skill Training and Employment Zone Development Scheme to train youth and boost employment. The scheme is designed to address industry requirements and connect young people with job opportunities both domestically and abroad. Uttar Pradesh hosts approximately 96 lakh MSME enterprises, accounting for 14.2 percent of the country's total enterprises and contributing heavily to state exports.

freepressjournal.in: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Nagaland Launches Samaveshi Aajeevika Yojana

Nagaland launched the Samaveshi Aajeevika Yojana (SAY-SOBLOK) via a three-year MoU between NSRLM and BRAC International. The programme aims to support 4,000 extremely vulnerable households in the state to escape extreme poverty. It operates under the wider framework of the Deen Dayal Antyodaya Yojana–National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM). The initiative adopts BRAC International's Graduation Approach, providing a structured, time-bound method for sustainable livelihoods.

drishtiias.com: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Keralam Cabinet clears Bill to guarantee rights for senior citizens

The Keralam Cabinet cleared a bill to provide a legal guarantee for the care and protection of senior citizens. The trigger is the changing demographic pattern, rising life expectancy, and concerns over elderly neglect as younger people move abroad. The core issue is addressing the isolation and medical needs of aged couples and individuals living alone due to brain drain.

The Hindu: source

DEFENCE | QUICK READ

INDIAN NAVY SET TO COMMISSION INDIGENOUS ANTI-SUBMARINE WARFARE SHALLOW WATER CRAFT ‘MANGROL’

Mangrol, the third Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft, is set to be commissioned into the Indian Navy at Naval Dockyard, Mumbai. The commissioning ceremony will be presided over by Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan, Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Western Naval Command. The ship has been built by Cochin Shipyard Limited, Kochi, under the government's Make in India and Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiatives.

The Hindu: source

ECONOMY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

RBI study fills four-month gap in state inflation data using survey inputs

Researchers published a study detailing how they successfully bridged a four-month gap in state-level urban inflation data. An RBI study used household survey inputs and past data to estimate missing state-wise urban inflation figures during a data gap. Researchers used household perceptions, expectations and past data to estimate missing state-wise urban inflation, with refined figures closely tracking the all-India series

Business Standard: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

India’s rural gender gap in upper-secondary completion remains stark despite wider progress: UNESCO report

India shows progress in closing education gender gaps, but a stark rural-urban divide leaves girls behind at the upper-secondary level. The UNESCO Global Education Monitoring report reveals that only 59 girls complete upper-secondary school for every 100 boys in rural India. India's overall adjusted gender parity index for upper-secondary completion stands at 0.89, while urban areas have achieved parity.

Hindustan Times: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED | SCHEME | DAY/OBSERVANCE | QUICK READ

Odisha Launches Commercial Layer Farming Scheme on World Egg Day 2026

The scheme was launched to coincide with World Egg Day 2026. Odisha has launched a commercial layer farming scheme on the occasion of World Egg Day 2026 to boost local egg production.

Pragativadi: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | SCHEME | DAY/OBSERVANCE | QUICK READ

India and Mali commemorate World Cotton Day at United Nations Headquarters in New York

India and Mali jointly organized an event titled Cotton for Sustainability at the UN Headquarters in New York on October 7, 2026. The event commemorated World Cotton Day, which was proclaimed by the UN General Assembly through Resolution 75/318. Discussions focused on cotton's contribution to livelihoods, poverty alleviation, economic development, and the Sustainable Development Goals.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Keralam govt. to present resolution in Assembly seeking return of Private Universities Bill

The government is invoking the provisions of Article 201 of the Constitution concerning Bills reserved for the President. The Kerala government is bringing a resolution in the state Assembly to demand the return of the Private Universities Bill. The government is seeking to get the Bill returned to the House under the conditions set in Article 201 of the Constitution which deals with Bills reserved for consideration of the President

The Hindu: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

BRICS adopts Labour Declaration, India launches 'BRICS CONNECT' at Hyderabad meeting

BRICS countries adopted a landmark Labour and Employment Ministers' Declaration in Hyderabad focusing on social protection and digital technologies. India launched BRICS CONNECT to enhance technical cooperation, knowledge exchange, and capacity building among member nations. The 12th BRICS meeting was held under India's 2026 Chairship with the theme Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability.

ddnews.gov.in: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

ReNew Signs INR 70,000 Crore Pact for Green Data Centre Park in Maharashtra

The signing of the high-value investment pact between ReNew and the Maharashtra government put the project in the news. ReNew signed a pact worth INR 70,000 crore to build a green data centre park in Maharashtra.

Energetica India Magazine: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Madhya Pradesh Abolition of Cash Grants Act Struck Down: Supreme Court's Take

The Supreme Court delivered its verdict on the constitutional validity of the Madhya Pradesh Abolition of Cash Grants Act. The Supreme Court struck down the Madhya Pradesh Abolition of Cash Grants Act, declaring it invalid.

The Law Observer: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

Census 2027: Ensure every individual is counted, says Registrar General

The Registrar General made these directives during a review meeting with census officials regarding the preparation for Census 2027. The Registrar General of India instructed census officials in Andhra Pradesh to complete the second phase of Census 2027 accurately and within deadlines. Mrityunjay Kumar Narayan asks census officials in Andhra Pradesh to complete the second phase with accuracy and within deadlines

The Hindu: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Nation has been driven back: Supreme Court laments its own 1987 judgment on condonation of delay

The Supreme Court dismissed appeals by Karvy Stock Broking and its former chairman challenging SAT orders that rejected condonation of delay. Appellants approached the apex court after the Securities Appellate Tribunal refused to condone delays in challenging financial penalties imposed by SEBI. The core issue concerned whether courts should routinely adopt a liberal approach to condoning procedural delays under the doctrine of substantial justice.

Bar & Bench: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY | QUICK READ

Cabinet approves Rs. 1,264 crore Ballari–Guntakal rail multitracking project

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved the third and fourth railway lines on the Ballari–Guntakal section. The project spans across Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh at an estimated cost of Rs. 1,264 crore. The core issue addressed is improving rail capacity, reducing congestion, and ensuring seamless freight and passenger movement. The project will add around 46 km to the existing railway network and is scheduled for completion by 2028-29.

ddnews.gov.in: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

New CAPF Act Takes Effect, Reserves Top CRPF, BSF, CISF, ITBP and SSB Posts for IPS Officers

The Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration) Act, 2026 came into force across the country on October 8, 2026, establishing a common legal framework for recruitment and service conditions. The new law covers five major security forces: CRPF, BSF, CISF, ITBP, and SSB, replacing divergent rules and addressing past service-related litigations.

indianmasterminds.com: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

ICAR and the Agriculture Department of Seychelles ink MoU for bilateral cooperation in agri research

The signing of the MoU between ICAR and Seychelles put the bilateral agricultural cooperation in the news. ICAR and the Agriculture Department of Seychelles have signed a Memorandum of Understanding to promote bilateral cooperation in agricultural research.

AgroSpectrum India: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | QUICK READ

UP cabinet approves sustainable aviation fuel policy 2026

The Uttar Pradesh cabinet approved the Sustainable Aviation Fuel Manufacturing Promotion Policy-2026 during a meeting in Lucknow. The policy was introduced to transform the state into India's premier manufacturing powerhouse for Sustainable Aviation Fuel. It aligns with global efforts to decarbonize the civil aviation sector and foster private sector innovation. The policy leverages local agricultural residues like rice husk, wheat straw, and sugarcane bagasse to diversify farmers' income.

msn.com: source

ECONOMY | QUICK READ

RBI cancels Certificate of Registration of 13 NBFCs

The Reserve Bank of India cancelled the Certificates of Registration of 13 Non-Banking Financial Companies, barring them from carrying out non-banking financial business. The central bank exercised powers conferred under Section 45-IA (6) of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934 for these cancellations. Out of the 13 cancelled NBFCs, 11 have registered offices in West Bengal and two are based in Tamil Nadu.

RBI: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

India reiterates ‘zero tolerance’ against cross-border terrorism at UNGA

An Indian parliamentary delegation participated in the United Nations General Assembly session in New York. Rajya Sabha MP Sikander Kumar led the Indian parliamentary delegation during the UNGA session. The delegation reiterated India's resolute stance of zero tolerance against cross-border terrorism. The Indian delegation held a bilateral meeting with Alexander Zouev, Acting Under-Secretary-General of UNOCT.

tribuneindia.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

Meghalaya’s edGrid Showcased at World Bank’s World Development Report 2026 India Launch as a Model for AI-Powered Education Governance

Meghalaya's edGrid was showcased as a select State AI innovation at the India launch of the World Bank Group's World Development Report 2026. The event was organized jointly by the IndiaAI Mission, MeitY, and the World Bank Group to examine AI adoption for development challenges. The platform addresses the core governance issue of using AI to connect education data, geography, and outcomes to daily government decisions.

aninews.in: source

HEALTH | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

Ayush Services Sector Report 2026: Key Findings for UPSC

The Ministry of Ayush highlighted findings from the Ayush Service Sector Report 2026 released on Ayurveda Day 2026. The assessment was conducted by the Research and Information System for Developing Countries to examine economic and employment contributions. Women constitute 43 percent of the overall Ayush services workforce, with representation exceeding 50 percent in organized segments.

insightsonindia.com: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 GS3 India’s ‘WorldSkills’ Medals Reflect Patient Investment

India secured the 10th position at the 48th WorldSkills Competition in Shanghai, China, in September 2026, entering the world's top ten for the first time. The country won six silver medals and 20 Medals for Excellence, improving upon its 2024 performance of four bronze medals and 12 Medals for Excellence. The author argues that this milestone highlights the value of practical skills, sustained investment in human resources, and greater social recognition for vocational careers.

The Hindu

GS2 BRICS in a fragmented world order, a test of relevance

The editorial was published in the wake of diplomatic discussions and the New Delhi summit concerning the future trajectory of BRICS. An editorial discussing the internal tensions, economic imbalances, and the test of relevance faced by the BRICS grouping in a fragmented world order. Despite diplomatic consensus at the New Delhi summit, BRICS faces internal tensions and imbalances

The Hindu

GS2 Beyond the CJI: What independence should mean for Election Commission appointments

The Supreme Court split in Dr Jaya Thakur v Union of India challenges Section 7 of the 2023 Act, which places the PM, LoP, and a Union Cabinet minister on the EC selection committee. Justice Dipankar Datta noted the LoP could become ornamental, while Justice Satish Chandra Sharma referred the constitutional question to a larger bench. The 2023 Act replaced the temporary selection committee setup by the Anoop Baranwal judgment, which included the CJI, the Prime Minister, and the Leader of the Opposition.

Deccan Herald

GS3 Repo rate hike is a necessary check

The Reserve Bank of India increased the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.5% in a unanimous call by the Monetary Policy Committee. The MPC also delivered a 4-2 verdict shifting its monetary stance from neutral to calibrated tightening, indicating no near-term easing. This latest hike is the first since February 2023, following cumulative cuts of 125 basis points in 2025 and a subsequent hold at 5.25%.

Deccan Herald

GS3 Mint Quick Edit | India's latest GST reforms should help turn production more competitive

The editorial discusses the GST Council's latest reform package, which aims to ease processes and compliance while unlocking working capital for businesses. A big gain will be the working capital that would be unlocked—especially for businesses with long or highly taxed supply chains. The changes deserve a warm welcome.

Mint

GS3 Delivery completed: on the GST Council meet, reforms

The latest GST Council meeting and its reform announcements put the tax regime in the news. The editorial examines the recent reforms recommended by the GST Council, assessing their role in transforming the indirect tax into a simpler system. With the latest reforms, GST might finally become a 'good and simple tax'

The Hindu

GS2 India's criminal codes say nothing about facial recognition tools. 3 amendments can fix this

The Delhi Police used facial recognition at the Jantar Mantar protests in July and told the Supreme Court in August that the system identified 2,873 people with criminal records. A subsequent report found that 22 of those individuals were lodged in prison during the protests, highlighting a gap in legal regulation for such software. India's new criminal codes focus on recording evidence gathering but omit regulations for the software that decides whom police should target.

ThePrint

GS3 Apple Pay's India launch shows how RBI's outcome-based regulation lets technology evolve

Apple Pay arrived in India on September 30, twelve years after its global debut, enabling users to pay via iPhones, iPads, and Apple Watches without an OTP. The launch was made possible by a regulatory breakthrough rather than just a commercial one, moving away from mandating OTPs which had become targets for fraudsters. The core issue is how regulation should adapt to new technologies like device-native biometrics while maintaining security, consumer protection, accountability, and interoperability.

Economic Times

GS2 As Yemen's old conflict flares up, a test for Mecca pact

Yemeni long war flared up again as a spillover of the United States-Iran conflict along the Red Sea coast. Saudi-backed Yemeni government forces sought to secure the Bab el-Mandeb Strait while Iran-backed Houthis struck Saudi airports and oil facilities. The 2022 United Nations-brokered truce largely froze fighting and allowed the Houthis to regroup before they began targeting Israel-linked ships during the Gaza war.

msn.com

GS1 GS2 Be mindful, listen, empathise: Is modern life killing our mental health? New findings reveal alarming truths about social isolation

World Mental Health Day focuses on the theme 'Lived experiences heard: Real voices, real change', emphasizing engagement with people with lived experience of mental health conditions. Alienation and isolation define the current decade, with people feeling increasingly cut off and lonely despite numerous ways to connect online and offline. Evolutionary biology shows that human consciousness and empathy evolved to keep complex social relationships stable and foster cooperation.

Economic Times

GS2 Palestinians have become a footnote in Middle East politics. It is all about Iran now

Three years after the October 7, 2023 Hamas attacks on Israel, the Middle East faces ongoing multi-layered wars involving Iran, its proxies, and Arab states. Historically, Arab states fought multiple wars against Israel before shifting toward bilateral peaces like the 1978 Egypt and 1994 Jordan agreements. The 2020 Abraham Accords and the proposed India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC) marked a shift toward regional economic integration while sidelining the Palestinian issue.

ThePrint

GS4 (Good) poetry can hone AI-HI skill sets

The article argues that poetry hones human intelligence by developing cognitive skills like interpretative flexibility and focus, which are crucial in the age of artificial intelligence. The recent Nobel Prize in Literature awarded to Anne Carson highlights a pivotal truth: poetry nurtures human intelligence. It acts as a vital exercise in cognitive skills such as interpretative flexibility and focus. In an age where AI is rapidly advancing, the ability to engage meaningfully with poetry sets individuals apart, enhancing their creative prowess.

Economic Times

GS3 Best of Opinion: Central banks need to be ready for geopolitical risks

Published as part of the best of opinion series examining contemporary economic policies and institutional reforms. Opinion pieces discuss how central banks must prepare for geopolitical risks alongside issues like integrated transport planning and RoDTEP uncertainty. From integrated transport planning and uncertainty over Rodtep to the RBI's geopolitical challenges, family business governance, today's opinions examine policy and institutional reform

Business Standard

GS2 To select independent ECs, look beyond the CJI

The author argues that appointment method alone cannot predict the future conduct or independence of Election Commissioners. Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi reportedly recorded objections on 14 occasions over 10 months under the 2023 appointment regime. Indian law offers varied appointment models for public institutions, with several committees having a majority of government members. Bodies like the CBI and Lokpal use broader selection committees that include the CJI, Leader of the Opposition, or judicial members.

Deccan Herald

GS2 The invisible hand, of the Nobel kind

The piece reflects on the role and limitations of Nobel Prizes in shaping the global research and academic landscape. The editorial discusses how Nobel Prizes influence research priorities, noting that their validation process often lags and traditional peer review remains more reliable. Nobel Prizes aim to rectify shortcomings in the research landscape by encouraging exceptional initiatives. Although they celebrate noteworthy achievements, their validation process often lags, prioritizing established consensus over emerging ideas and team-based projects.

Economic Times

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Stubble Burning – Causes & Consequences Stubble burning is the practice of setting fire to leftover crop residues like paddy stubble after harvesting to clear fields quickly. The practice is driven by short windows between paddy harvesting and wheat sowing, labour shortages, and mechanised harvesting methods.

ForumIAS

Knowledge Nugget | What does the World Bank report say about India's AI readiness? The release of the World Bank report evaluating India's artificial intelligence ecosystem and readiness. An explainer detailing the World Bank report's findings on India's preparedness to adopt and scale artificial intelligence technologies.

Indian Express

What are the reforms proposed by the GST Council? The 57th GST Council approved a series of process reforms on October 8, including simplified registration procedures and system-driven approvals. The reforms aim to overhaul GST administration and reduce compliance burdens for businesses, particularly the real estate sector. Proposed changes to dispute resolution include streamlining demand notices, adjudication orders, and appeal orders with better justifications.

The Hindu

Reduced dependence on H-1B visas: Why Indian IT stocks rose despite US' employment shock The explainer highlights why Indian information technology equities showed resilience following US labour market data. Indian IT stocks rose despite weak employment signals from the United States, attributed to reduced reliance on H-1B visas.

Indian Express

India-Turkey ties: Why discord over Kashmir hasn't stopped sporadic cooperation The ongoing geopolitical tensions and periodic diplomatic friction regarding regional sovereignty put India-Turkey ties in the news. An analysis of the complex diplomatic relationship between India and Turkey, examining how bilateral cooperation persists despite strong political discord over Kashmir.

Indian Express

What are stem-cell donor registries and how do they work? Experts highlighted the urgent need for India to build a larger and more diverse donor pool to improve match outcomes. Stem-cell donor registries provide access to potential unrelated donors for patients requiring a transplant but lacking a suitable family donor.

The Hindu

Mint explainer: how will the Rs. 10,000 crore SME Growth Fund (SGF) help Indian MSMEs? The fund is in the news following official announcements detailing its structure and objectives to plug the funding gap for small businesses. The Rs. 10,000 crore SME Growth Fund is a government initiative designed to provide equity capital to Indian MSMEs to help them expand, adopt technology, and compete globally.

Mint

Kerala HC directs FIR against former CM Pinarayi Vijayan: What is the CMRL-Exalogic case? The Kerala High Court directed the State Police Chief to register an FIR against former Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan, his daughter Veena T, and her husband P A Mohammad Riyas.
newindianexpress.com

Noida Jewar airport is now Narendra Modi International Airport: How are airports named, renamed? The Yogi Adityanath Cabinet passed a proposal to rename the upcoming Noida International Airport in Jewar as Narendra Modi International Airport. The decision honours Prime Minister Narendra Modi completing 25 years of uninterrupted public service as head of government.
thehansindia.com

Explained | What is Meta's Muse AI agent and its advanced capabilities Meta recently announced the Muse AI Agent, a more advanced product than the standard Meta AI chatbot, powered by Muse Spark Large Language Models. The AI agent is designed to perform actionable multi-step tasks with minimal supervision, going beyond simple conversations.
deccanherald.com

Quantum computers aren't powerful enough to hack banks yet. So why are they preparing? Financial regulators and banks are preparing for future quantum computers that could defeat current encryption used in online banking and payments. The primary concern is not an immediate hack, but the lengthy time required to overhaul the global financial system's security architecture.
theprint.in

CJP protest on October 10: SC's order on Delhi restrictions explained in 10 points The Supreme Court questioned sweeping transport restrictions in Delhi ahead of the Cockroach Janata Party protest on October 10. A bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant heard petitions challenging the closure of 57 metro stations and long-distance train cancellations.
Times of India

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- RBI should widen LAF corridor to stabilise financial markets: SBI report (Economy) Business Standard
- Record all schemes' benefits for Scheduled Caste: Centre to bankers committees (Social Justice & Welfare) Hindustan Times
- India's logistics sector eyes $600 billion by 2031-32; cost pegged at 8% of GDP: DPIIT official (Economy) BusinessLine
- India showcases AI gains in farming and healthcare as World Bank launches report: Vaishnaw (Science & Technology) Indian Television Dot Com
- Release of Draft Guideline for Compilation Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) Estimates by Expenditure Approach with Base Year 2022-23 (Economy) PIB
- India's forex reserves drop for fourth week, down $12.95 bn to $734.6 bn (Economy) Business Standard
- INAUGURATION OF PROJECT SEABIRD INFRASTRUCTURE BY GENERAL N S RAJA SUBRAMANI, CDS AND SECRETARY, DMA (Defence) PIB
- BRICS and CBAM: Challenges for India and Global Trade (International Relations) NEXT IAS
- Two new species of springtails discovered by scientists in Nilgiris (Environment & Ecology) The New Indian Express
- Maha Cabinet approves cyclotron project in Nagpur to boost cancer care (Health) DD News
- US green card suspension: What it means for Indian IT workers on H-1B visas (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- GST Council proposes 5% GST rate for EV-based transport and rental services (Economy) Business Standard
- Union Health Ministry to Observe World Mental Health Day 2026, Reaffirming Commitment to Accessible, Inclusive and People-Centred Mental Healthcare (Health) PIB
- IRDAI may roll out insurance commission caps from January, overhaul distribution rules (Economy) The Economic Times
- Uttar Pradesh Leads in PM Surya Ghar Solar Scheme Implementation (Infrastructure & Energy) The News Agency
- Govt advises social media platforms to exercise enhanced diligence on information disseminated on their platforms (Governance & Policy) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- It's been our consistent position that UNMOGIP outlived its relevance after Simla Agreement: MEA (International Relations) Greater Kashmir
- Supreme Court Hears Objection To Word 'Preparation' In Orders On Sexual Acts Short Of Penetration (Polity & Constitution) LawChakra
- Ladakh admin launches Changthang vision report for conservation, sustainable livelihoods (Environment & Ecology) ThePrint
- Revitalization of UNGA should be part of broader UN reforms: India's MP CP Joshi at UNGA plenary (International Relations) ANI News
- Supreme Court to Hold National Consultation on 10 Years of Juvenile Justice Act on October 10–11 (Polity & Constitution) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- An Instafamous giant water lily is confirmed as a new species (Environment & Ecology) Mongabay News
- PM Modi, Indonesian President inaugurate India-backed restoration of UNESCO (International Relations) DD News
- 'UP Cabinet approves third phase of Lucknow naval museum project' (History, Art & Culture) ThePrint
- Jamaat won't accept constitutional amendments that bypass referendum verdict, vows to step up street protests (International Relations) Prothom Alo English

- Why do Google and Meta want the Digital Competition Bill diluted, while Indian startups want it passed? (Governance & Policy) MediaNama
- Magnitude 7.6 earthquake shakes Panama, USGS reports (Geography) The Hindu
- Supreme Court seeks Centre, states' response on deaths of 32 tribal children in MP (Social Justice & Welfare) Hindustan Times
- India's share of global greenfield investments more than double China's in 2020-25 (Economy) The Hindu
- India, Japan unveil ambitious AI roadmap, deepen cooperation on governance, innovation and talent (International Relations) DD News
- Why the RBI raised interest rates despite growth concerns (Economy) The Hindu
- Government Approves Cancer Medicine Trade-Margin Cap (Health) GKToday
- India, Australia deepen defence ties as Rajnath Singh and Richard Marles co-chair Defence Ministers' Dialogue (International Relations) DD News
- India, Australia seal uranium deal, to enhance defence and maritime cooperation (International Relations) DD News
- India's Bimal Patel elected judge of International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (International Relations) DD News
- From 3 GW to 162 GW: The rise of India's solar power sector (Environment & Ecology) DD News
- GST rejig: Credit relief, export push and simpler rules make Diwali come early for industry, says EY's Bipin Sapra (Economy) Economic Times
- Compensation for Land Acquisition: Supreme Court Clarifies Statutory Allowance Under Section 23(2) (Polity & Constitution) The Law Observer
- Reforms, progress and liftoff: India's space sector enters a new era with launch of Vikram-1 (Science & Technology) DD News
- Iran claims attack on LPG tanker, says vessels trying to cross Strait of Hormuz will be 'punished' (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- The 1945 Trap Explained: Why World Leaders Are Pushing For Security Council Reforms (International Relations) The Times of India
- 'Serious blow': Guterres condemns new US sanctions on International Criminal Court (International Relations) UN News
- 'Green strategic partnership will strengthen cooperation': PM Modi after talks with Norway PM Jonas Gahr Støre (International Relations) DD News
- PM Modi launches projects worth Rs 19,480 crore in Assam's Guwahati; releases Rs 18,000 crore under PM-Kisan (Governance & Policy) DD News
- EC divide raises questions over autonomy (Polity & Constitution) Pioneer Daily
- Defence secretary outlines reforms to speed up arms procurement and expand $25bn domestic industry (Defence) The News Mill
- Starlink vs India: Why sovereignty and security concerns outweigh Musk's outcry (Science & Technology) ET Government
- Xi Jinping urges BRICS to mediate Middle East conflict, vows deeper India ties (International Relations) scanx.trade

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 23 must-know, 23 Prelims facts, 48 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Economy (11), Polity & Constitution (8), International Relations (8), Governance & Policy (7), Health (3), Defence (2), Social Justice & Welfare (2), Agriculture & Allied (2), Infrastructure & Energy (2), Environment & Ecology (1). **Nothing today in —** Education, Science & Technology, Internal Security, Disaster Management, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 2 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 2 · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 2 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 2

Full text — 49 of 73 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — ddnews.gov.in 12, The Hindu 10, Economic Times 7, PIB 3, Business Standard 3, Hindustan Times 3, Deccan Herald 3, Indian Express 3, drishtiias.com 2, RBI 2, msn.com 2, Mint 2, ThePrint 2, nextias.com 1

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